

### Woz Stands In Line!

The iPhone, like the Grim Reaper, is a great leveller. Steve Wozniak, the iconic co-founder of Apple, was spotted with ordinary folks outside an Apple store—that's no typo—waiting his turn for an iPhone. (because he'd have to wait for his complimentary phone!)



### Google Cash-strapped

Now this one tickled us no end: when we last checked, Google was sitting on, oh, billions of dollars in profits. Even so, one blogger was issued a cheque—which bounced—for AdSense earnings. And he told all. (Probably kept and framed the cheque, actually.)



# Escape

## SPEED DEMONESS

### Granny Has Fastest Internet

A lucky few of us in India are rejoicing over our new, fast 2 Mbps Internet connections. Yes, those of us who do have such speeds at home—especially the rich few who even have it unlimited—look down upon the hoi polloi. We even wear T-shirts that say “2M. Eat that, 56K.”

Sigbritt Löthberg, a 75-year-old granny in Sweden would kindly approve. She just got a 40 Gbps connection.

Wait. Did we write that right? Yes, we did, and we hope you read that right, too. It's about 20,000 times faster than 2 Mbps, and 6 lakh 40 thousand times faster than dial-up. OK, we can't have made typos writing all that out.

Interesting how such news spreads with such rapidity over the fibres, as it were... Löthberg's home connection happens to be the fastest residential

Internet connection on the planet. (So OK, our jaws needn't drop any further.)

Löthberg can download a full-length dual-layer DVD in two seconds, or watch 1,500 HDTV channels streamed simultaneously. So how did she land up with this kind of whatever-you-may-call-it speeds? Well, it pays to have a son who happens to be one of the leading authorities on the theory of fibre optics.

What puts the steam into the lightning-fast connection (sorry, mixed metaphor) is a new data modulation technique that allows direct transfers between two routers that can be as far as 2000 km apart, without any intermediary nodes. (The distance between the routers can theoretically be unlimited.)

It's time to reveal the hardest part-to-digest of the story—(wails of pain here)—the hardest part of getting

the connection to work was the installation of Windows on the ancient computer Löthberg uses. And she uses it rarely, we hear.

With that revealed, let's see what Löthberg might do with her connection, in increasing order of horror:

- ❑ Download Windows updates
- ❑ Chat with relatives abroad
- ❑ Play Yahoo! Games with jovial granny-friends right in Sweden
- ❑ Search for recipes online...

Friends, philosophical resignation is the only solace. Hawking was right. Life isn't fair.

## GRAND SLOTH

### When Gamers Go Bad

Teenagers with no social lives who spend hours upon hours in a dark room, shut off from the rest of the world,

## Whatever Happened To...

### Interactive Movies

Back around 1998, some bright folks came up with the idea that movies should start getting *interactive*, that audiences in movie theatres and at home should get the option of choosing which way the movie would progress. Should the actor kiss his leading lady? Should the lady in question swoon or slap the man? The way the story flowed would be in the hands of the viewer.

Interactive movies were proposed to work on the principle that audiences in theatres would be given a four-button remote-control-like device, and that key twists in the plot would be decided by a real-time poll in the theatre. The movie would progress in the direction of the option with the most votes. Producers thought getting to a popular conclusion would keep everyone happy...

The idea never caught on (we sort of knew back then it wouldn't). Producers quickly realised they would have to shoot many more reels of film to accommodate the different twists and turns; conducting a poll while the movie was on could have been a tad irritating. You don't want to be asked if Salman Khan should take off his shirt!

Still, thanks to higher bandwidths and ever-falling production rates, interactive movies have taken to the Internet. A site catering to this whim, if you do feel compelled, is [www.interactive-film.com](http://www.interactive-film.com).

## Win! My Desktop

**Sandip Dev** from Nagaon confused us a bit with his desktop—it looks like a crazy mix of Vista and Mac OS X, but it's really Ubuntu.

*How he did it:*

**The top panel:** Use GIMP to create a silver gradient background of 24 pixels height and width equal to desktop horizontal resolution. Blacken some of the pixels from the corners to give a rounded look

**The Apple logo:** Get the Apple logo from the Net and convert it to .svg. Name it start-here.svg and copy it to /usr/share/icons/Ubuntu/scalable/places as root(gksudo)

For the Volume meter, CPU meter, Battery Meter, Inbox and Calendar, use gdesklets

Participate in this contest and win next month

**Mastering Maya 8.5**

by John Kundert-Gibbs

Published by **WILEY-INDIA**



Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to [mydesktop@thinkdigit.com](mailto:mydesktop@thinkdigit.com) with the subject “My Desktop”, and tell us your postal address, too.